2013
Community forest title granted to Ghatbarra village (810 ha)

→

2016
Titles cancelled by the district, for coal mining

CANCELLED

→

2025
High Court dismisses the village's challenge

AGRICULTURE

Chhattisgarh Govt. Cancels Tribal Rights Over Forests to Facilitiate Coal Mining



Nitin Sethi
Feb 17 2016

It is the first such order to come to light across the country where community rights of tribals have been summarily cancelled after being granted through process laid down in the FRA.



Ghatbarra's forest rights: granted and cancelled

September 2013, January 2016, October 2025 · District forest rights committee; Chhattisgarh High Court · News report: The Wire, 17 Feb 2016

Under the Forest Rights Act, Ghatbarra's gram sabha received community title over its forest in 2013. On 8 January 2016 the district cancelled it, because the coal block had been cleared in 2012. The Act has no provision for revoking such titles; the High Court still upheld the cancellation.

Full reports on the desk: The Wire (2016), Down To Earth (2025).